

READING LABELS, CHANGING LIVES

NITYA HEGDE'S NUTRITION

COMMUNITY BUILT ON SIMPLICITY

"My journey started with a genuine intention to educate and share mindful eating habits," says Nitya Hegde. Beginning with simple ideas like reading ingredient labels, even for a small audience, her content has always been rooted in clarity and purpose. Over time, that honesty and simplicity struck a chord, helping her build a community that values conscious food choices. It also proved how small, consistent nudges can reshape how people think about what they eat.

How are you different from other nutrition-based creators?

My content is centered around simple, practical vegetarian food with nutrition as the backbone. I focus on making healthy eating approachable using everyday ingredients, traditional wisdom, and easy methods. What makes my content unique is the balance between nourishment and relatability, food that satisfies both the heart and the body. I aim to show that healthy eating doesn't have to be complicated, expensive, or restrictive.

What are some misconceptions around being a creator?

People often see only the final video, but not the thought, research, testing, and consistency behind it. Creating meaningful

content requires discipline and responsibility, especially when you are educating people about health and nutrition. It's not just about following trends; it's about building trust over time.

Challenges faced and opportunities gained in this journey?

One of the biggest challenges is balancing authenticity with trends. There is often pressure to create viral content, but I chose to stay consistent with my values. Another challenge in my early days was limited brand collaborations because I avoided promoting products with refined sugar, artificial flavours, or preservatives. However, staying true to my philosophy helped build long-term credibility. India also offers a huge opportunity because of its diverse food culture and increasing awareness around health.

Chasing revenue vs creating a unique voice, what's more important?

I believe creators should focus on building a strong, unique voice first. Revenue follows when trust is built. In my early days, I consciously chose not to promote products that didn't align with my values. I declined many brand collaborations, especially those involving highly processed foods or products with refined sugar, artificial flavours, and preservatives. This made monetiza-

tion slower initially. At the same time, I'm always open to promoting brands that genuinely offer good-quality products with clean ingredients. When a product aligns with my philosophy and is something I would personally use or give to my family, I'm happy to support it.

What's your view on using AI in content creation?

AI is a useful tool for improving efficiency, brainstorming ideas, and structuring content. However, overusing it can dilute originality and personal voice. Creators should use AI as a support system rather than a replacement for creativity.

How are creators such as yourself making a difference?

Creators today are building communities and influencing everyday habits. In the health and nutrition space, we are encouraging mindful eating, ingredient awareness, and sustainable food choices. This goes beyond entertainment - it's about shaping healthier lifestyles. **d**